Lab 2 — Agile Backlog Creation & Sprint Simulation in Jira

Software Engineering (UE24CS341A) — Semester 5, Section F
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Scenario: Problem #39 — Second-Hand Product Escrow Marketplace

1. Jira setup

Project	SE Project — SCRUM (company-managed)
Board	SP board
Epic	Secure Escrow Transaction Flow
Sprint	Sprint 1 — 11 Sep – 13 Sep 2026 (1-week timebox)
Estimation	Planning Poker on the Fibonacci scale
Prioritisation	High / Medium / Low by user impact

User stories created from the Lab 1 functional requirements (status at the mid-sprint snapshot):

Issue	User story	Traces to	Status
SP-7	Story 1.1 — Lock Payment in Escrow	FR-001	In Progress
SP-8	Story 1.2 — Order State Transition	FR-001	To Do
SP-9	Story 1.3 — Inspector Sign-Off	FR-002	To Do
SP-10	Story 1.4 — Fund Release on Approval	FR-003	Done
SP-11	Story 1.5 — Dispute Freeze	FR-005 / NFR-001	Done

2. Reflection questions

Q1. Did your estimations reflect the actual effort?

Only partly. The estimates were derived from the happy path of each story, so the stories that looked conceptually simple were sized low. In practice the effort in the escrow domain lives in edge cases — dual-condition verification before release, rollback when settlement fails, and the tamper-evident audit write on every state change — none of which were visible when the cards were first estimated. Sprint 1 finished with only two of five stories in Done, with the core escrow locking story (SP-7) still In Progress. That is direct evidence that the money-handling stories were estimated optimistically; the gap was in unestimated edge-case work, not in the features themselves.

Q2. Was your backlog well-prioritized?

At the epic level, yes. The Secure Escrow Transaction Flow epic sequences the stories in strict dependency order — lock funds → transition order state → inspector sign-off → release funds → dispute freeze — so no story depends on work scheduled later in the backlog, and the two stories tied to the hard NFRs (fund release, dispute freeze) were prioritised High. The weakness is housekeeping: the backlog still carried unused example/template items (the coffee-ordering “Story 1.1 / 1.2” cards first surfaced by the Jira tutorial) alongside the real escrow stories. They should have been deleted during grooming — leaving them in inflates the backlog and makes priority ordering ambiguous.

Q3. How did your simulated sprint align with your plan?

The timebox and the sprint goal were respected: the sprint ran its fixed 1-week window and the goal (“deliver the escrow transaction flow incrementally”) was clear and singular. Where plan and reality diverged was scope vs. capacity. The plan committed all five stories to Sprint 1, but the snapshot shows

two completed, one in progress and two untouched. Progress did move through the correct flow (To Do → In Progress → Done) as work was simulated, so the board mechanics matched the plan; the velocity assumption did not. The realistic throughput was closer to two stories per sprint than five.

Q4. What insights did the burndown chart give about your team's capacity?

The burndown line stayed almost flat early in the sprint and then dropped in discrete steps, rather than declining smoothly toward the grey ideal-progress guide. A stepped burndown means work is only recognised as done in batches (stories were closed together after review), and a line that sits above the guideline means the committed scope was larger than capacity. The actionable insight is that the team's sustainable velocity is below what Sprint 1 committed: the next sprint should pull fewer points than the raw backlog total and explicitly reserve capacity for the escrow stories that keep slipping, instead of assuming every high-priority story fits in one timebox.

3. Traceability to Lab 1

Lab 1 requirement	Jira user story
FR-001 Lock payment / state — Under Inspection	SP-7, SP-8
FR-002 Inspection certification (approve / reject)	SP-9
FR-003 Release funds on dual verification	SP-10
FR-004 Escrow service fee + digital receipt	(carried to next sprint)
FR-005 Buyer dispute freezes funds	SP-11
NFR-001 Immediate freeze / no withdrawals	SP-11
NFR-002 Tamper-evident audit log	cross-cutting (SP-7…SP-11)